Breathing techniques is for pain relief during labour. Exhale before inhale is suggested.



- Abdominal breathing
- Lower coastal breathing
- Apical breathing

Back and Abdominal Exercise

Sit on a chair with your back against the seat back. Breathe normally, tightens the abdomen and then press the pelvis downwards to flattens your low back against the seat back. Hold for 5 seconds and relax.

This exercise helps mother by correcting the low back and pelvic posture. It strengthens your abdominal muscles and prevents back pain.

Pelvic floor exercises

Kegels exercise is a special exercise squeeze the pubococcygeal muscle or 3 seconds relax for 3 seconds and squeeze again. It can be done 100 times twice daily for keeping the vagina toned and increase the strength of perineum to avoid birth injuries.

Sit on chair with your back against seat back.

Tightens the vaginal, urethral and anal muscles as if trying to withhold urination or defecation. Should do this exercise in a standing position.

Pelvic floor exercise enhances the pelvic floor muscles. It helps in preparation for child birth and prevents uterine prolapsed, urinary incontinence and hemorrhoids.

Lower Limb Relaxation Exercises

- This exercise enhance the flexibility and strength of inner thighs and pelvic muscles. It helps to accustoms to the delivery position and prevent thigh spasm during delivery.
- Sit on table, low chair against a wall and spread your thighs sideways. Hold for 5 seconds and relax.

Lower limb relaxation exercise is suitable for pregnant women with tight thighs and not suitable for those with the pain over the pubic bones.

Foot and Ankle Exercises

- Sit on chair with your back against your seatback with one ankle and turn foot upwards and downwards. Each up and down is as one time, repeat 10 times.
- Repeat the ankle to draw inward and outward circle circular movement counted as one time.
- Repeat the same step at the other ankle.
- Ankle exercise helps to reduce leg swelling and varicose vein thus alleviating the problems of leg cramps.

Exercises and Activities to be avoided during Pregnancy

- Activities that require extensive jumping, hopping, skipping, bouncing.
- Double leg raises, deep knee bends.
- Trunk rotation while standing.
- Exercises in hot and humid weather.
- Bouncing while stretching.

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